

Facilitator Guide – Dell Inspiron and Dell Vostro



Author: M.Balasubramanian

Table of Contents

1. Introduction	1
1.1. Purpose	1
1.2. Intended Audiences	1
1.3. Scope.....	1
1.4. Trademarks and Copyright.....	1
1.5. Document Conventions	1
1.6. Acronyms and Abbreviations.....	1
1.7. Document Organization.....	2
2. Why a Laptop?	3
2.1. Laptops Vs Desktops.....	3
2.2. Laptops Vs Tablets/Smartphones	4
3. Dell Laptops	5
4. Dell Inspiron	6
4.1. Inspiron R.....	6
4.2. Inspiron Z	7
4.3. Inspiron	8
4.3.1. New Inspiron 11 3000 series	8
4.3.2. Inspiron 14 Laptop	9
4.3.3. Inspiron 15 Laptop.....	10
5. Dell Vostro	11

1. Introduction

Dell Inc. is a privately owned multinational computer technology company based in Round Rock, Texas (U.S.A.). Bearing the name of its founder, Michael Dell, the company is one of the largest technological corporations in the world, employing more than 103,300 people worldwide. Dell sells personal computers, servers, data storage devices, network switches, software, computer peripherals, Hi-Definition Televisions (HDTVs), cameras, printers, MP3 players and also electronics built by other manufacturers.

1.1. Purpose

The purpose of this document is to facilitate the user in their purchase of a Dell Inspiron/Vostro laptop.

1.2. Intended Audiences

The target audiences for this document are the customers and stakeholders of Dell Inc.

1.3. Scope

The document limits its scope to explain the features and benefits of the Dell Inspiron and Vostro laptops.

1.4. Trademarks and Copyright

The terms “Dell”, “Inspiron”, and “Vostro” are trademarks and copyrights of Dell, Inc. Any part of this document cannot be copied, re-written or reproduced without the express permission of Dell, Inc.

1.5. Document Conventions

- Throughout this document, the usage of the word “laptop” would cover the terms “laptop”, “notebook”, “netbook”, and other similar terms not mentioned here.
- It is assumed that the user of this document would be aware of the language and terminology used for computers and computer peripherals.
- All prices mentioned in this document have been taken from the Dell India Express Ship Affiliate compuindia’s site, www.compuindia.com.

1.6. Acronyms and Abbreviations

Term	Description
USP	Unique Selling Point
OS	Operating System
GB	Gigabyte
RAM	Random Access Memory
HD	Hi-Definition

HDD	Hard Disk Drive
HDTV	Hi-Definition Television
SSD	Solid State Drive
TB	Terabyte
WLED	White Light Emitting Diode

1.7. Document Organization

#	Chapter	Contents
1.	Introduction	Provides brief description about the document
2.	Why a Laptop?	Explains the advantages and disadvantages of a laptop and why users prefer a laptop.
3.	Dell PCs/Laptops	Gives an insight as to which brands are marketed in which segments with their USP.
4.	Dell Inspiron	Describes about which segment this brand is meant for and the current models available with their features.
5.	Dell Vostro	Describes about which segment this brand is meant for and the current models available with their features.

2. Why a Laptop?

Laptops are being used by people all over the world, right from a school student to a retired person. Even though there are alternatives available, the usage of laptop has not taken much of a hit. Let us take a look at some of the other reasons, by comparing the advantages/disadvantages of a laptop with some of the leading alternatives.

2.1. Laptops Vs Desktops

Topic	Laptop	Desktop
Cost	Laptop costs are higher than that of a desktop due to the fact that one cannot choose different components from different manufacturers. The average price of a laptop ranges anywhere between Rs. 15,000/- and Rs. 50,000/-, depending on the manufacturer, make and model of the laptop purchased	Desktops cost less compared to a laptop and have a wide variety of components to choose from. The average price of an unbranded desktop ranges anywhere between Rs. 10,000/- and Rs. 20,000/-, depending on the components purchased and assembled.
Portability and Usability	Due to their compact size, laptops are portable and ideal for users who travel a lot. This forms the key reason why laptops are purchased.	Desktops are large in size and have a separate monitor. They are meant for usage at a single place and not moved regularly. Accessibility, usability and portability become an issue for people “on-the-go”.
Keyboard	14” and 15” laptops have small keyboards with multiple functions assigned to most of the keys. However, the advent of 17” laptops has put an end to this issue. User can use wireless keyboard, if needed.	Desktops can make use of full size keyboards, including a number pad.
Screen size	The screen size of a laptop is lesser compared to a desktop ranging from 14” to 17”. However, connection to an external display like TV, projectors or screens is possible.	Desktop monitors range from 14” to 30”, with the flexibility to connect to external displays.
Upgrading	Most of the components are built-in. Only the memory and Hard Disk can be upgraded in a laptop. If any other component needs to be upgraded, a new laptop needs to be purchased. However, most of the laptops use state-of-the-art technology. The need to upgrade/replace components becomes redundant.	Most components in a desktop are easily removable, making it easier to upgrade. As the components are easily removable, there is the chance of equipment malfunctioning if the components are not fit properly.

Out of 100%, 81.5% purchased a desktop compared to 16.4% who bought laptops (Source: <http://www.statisticbrain.com/computer-sales-statistics/>). However, the percentage of laptop buyers is increasing due to the versatile needs of businesses today. The major factors for this are increased usage of computers by salespeople, number of people telecommuting from home, etc.

2.2. Laptops Vs Tablets/Smartphones

Topic	Laptop	Tablet/Smartphone
Cost	Laptop costs are higher than that of a tablet. The average price of a laptop ranges anywhere between Rs. 15,000/- and Rs. 50,000/-, depending on the manufacturer, make and model of the laptop purchased	Tablets cost cheaper than laptops. The average price of a tablet ranges anywhere between Rs. 2,000/- and Rs. 50,000/-, depending on the manufacturer, make and model of the tablet purchased
Portability and Usability	Due to their compact size, laptops are portable and ideal for users who travel a lot. This forms the key reason why laptops are purchased.	Tablets/Smartphones can be put into the pocket of the user and carried around more conveniently than a laptop. However, some functionalities like creating/editing a presentation, document, spreadsheet etc., are only available in high-end models.
Keyboard	14" and 15" laptops have small keyboards with multiple functions assigned to most of the keys. However, the advent of 17" laptops has put an end to this issue. User can use wireless keyboard, if needed.	There are no external keyboards. Will have to make use of the touch keyboard available or attach a Wi-Fi enabled keyboard.
Screen size	The screen size of a laptop is lesser compared to a desktop ranging from 14" to 17". However, connection to an external display like TV, projectors or screens is possible.	The screen-size of a tablet ranges from 4.3" to 10.1". The screen-size of a smartphone ranges from 3.5" to 8". Connection to an external display is possible.

Businesses still prefer usage of a laptop over tablets/smartphones to ensure security of information is maintained. Also most of the businesses require the use of facilities like Word, PPT and Excel to create documents, presentations and spreadsheets.

3. Dell Laptops

Specific brand names are marketed by the company catering to specific segments of the community. The following is a list of some leading brands of Dell marketed to home/home office and business/corporate segments.

Business/Corporate

The USP for these brands are long life-cycles, reliability and serviceability.

- OptiPlex (office desktop computer systems)
- Vostro (office/small business desktop and notebook systems)
- n Series (desktop and notebook computers shipped with Linux or FreeDOS installed)
- Latitude (business-focused notebooks)
- Precision (workstation systems and high-performance notebooks)

Home/Home Office

The USP for these brands are value, performance and expandability.

- Inspiron (budget desktop and notebook computers)
- Studio (mainstream desktop and laptop computers)
- XPS (high-end desktop and notebook computers)
- Studio XPS (high-end design-focus of XPS systems and extreme multimedia capability)
- Alienware (high-performance gaming systems)
- Adamo (high-end luxury laptop)
- Dell EMR (electronic medical records)

4. Dell Inspiron

This product line started off as an expensive entry-level computer and is currently poised as a mid-level computer system. In this document, we will limit our focus to the laptop range of Dell Inspiron. Although there have been many models introduced under this brand, the current top-selling models are

- [Inspiron R](#)
- [Inspiron Z](#)
- [Inspiron](#)

4.1. Inspiron R

The USP of this model is long battery life and stunning visuals. This model is available in two models, the 14" version and the 15" version. The following table lists a comparison of the features of both these models.



Features of Inspiron R series

Feature	Inspiron 14R	Inspiron 15R
Price	Rs. 42,390/-	Rs. 39,190/- to Rs. 66,990/-
Processor	3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i3-3227U	▪ 3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i3-3227U ▪ 3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i3-3227U ▪ 4th Gen Intel® Core™ i3-4010U ▪ 4th Gen Intel® Core™ i7-4500U
Operating System (OS)	Windows 8 Single Language	Windows 8 Single Language
Memory	4GB RAM, 500GB HDD	4-8GB RAM, 500GB-1TB HDD
Graphic Card	2GB NVidia® GeForce GT 730M	▪ Intel® HD Graphics 4400 ▪ 2GB AMD Radeon HD 8670M ▪ 2GB AMD Radeon HD 8670M GDDR3 ▪ 2GB AMD Radeon™ HD 8730M ▪ 2GB AMD Radeon HD 8850M
Display	14" HD WLED Display	▪ 15.6" HD WLED Display ▪ 15.6" HD WLED Truelife Display ▪ 15.6" HD WLED Touch Display
Security	McAfee® Security Center 15 Months	McAfee® Security Center 15 Months

🔗 The price for Inspiron 15R will vary depending on the model type chosen. Different model types are available with a combination of different types of processors, memory, graphic cards and display for Inspiron 15R.

4.2. Inspiron Z

The USP of this version is the availability of all the features of a regular laptop in an Ultrabook. Also, the touch functionality is available in Inspiron Z models. The following table lists a comparison of the features of the models of Inspiron Z.



Features of Inspiron 14Z series

Feature	Inspiron 14Z	Inspiron 14Z Ultrabook
Price	Rs. 35,990/-	Rs. 36,990/-
Processor	2nd Gen Intel® Core™ i3-2367M	3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i3-3217U
Operating System (OS)	Windows 8 Single Language	Windows 8 Single Language
Memory	4GB RAM, 500GB HDD	4GB RAM, 500GB HDD + 32GB SSD
Graphic Card	1GB AMD Radeon™ HD 7570M	1GB AMD Radeon™ HD 7570M
Display	14" HD WLED TrueLife	14" HD WLED Display
Security	McAfee® Security Center 15 Months	McAfee® Security Center 15 Months

Features of Inspiron 15Z series

Feature	Inspiron 15Z	Inspiron 15Z Ultrabook
Price	Rs. 53,790/-	Rs. 74,990/-
Processor	3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i5-3337U	3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i5-3537U
Operating System (OS)	Windows 8 Single Language	Windows 8 Single Language
Memory	8GB RAM, 500GB HDD + 32GB SSD	8GB RAM, 500GB HDD + 32GB SSD
Graphic Card	2GB NVidia® GeForce GT 630M	2GB NVidia® GeForce GT 630M
Display	15.6" HD WLED Display	15.6" LED Touch HD Display
Security	McAfee® Security Center 15 Months	McAfee® Security Center 15 Months

4.3. Inspiron

4.3.1. New Inspiron 11 3000 series

Everyday tasks can be performed with this compact, affordable and feature-rich laptop. An interactive touch screen and long battery life are its USPs. The following table lists the features of the laptop.



Features of New Inspiron 11 3000 series

Feature	Inspiron 11 3000 series
Price	Rs. 32,990/-
Processor	Intel® Celeron® processor 2955U
Operating System (OS)	Windows 8 Single Language
Memory	2GB RAM, 500GB HDD
Graphic Card	Intel® HD Graphics
Display	11.6" WLED Backlit Touch Display
Security	McAfee® Security Center 15 Months

4.3.2. Inspiron 14 Laptop

This laptop is budget-friendly, comes with a thin design and has up to 4th Generation Intel® Core™ processors.



Features of New Inspiron 14 Laptop series

Feature	Inspiron 14 Laptop series
Price	Rs. 32,890/- to Rs. 44,990/-
Processor	▪ 2nd Gen Intel® Core™ i3-2375M ▪ 3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i3-3217U ▪ 4th Gen Intel® Core™ i5-4200U
Operating System (OS)	▪ Ubuntu Linux 12.04 ▪ Windows 8 Single Language
Memory	2GB - 4GB RAM, 500GB HDD
Graphic Card	▪ Intel® HD Graphics 4000 ▪ 1GB NVidia® GeForce GT 625M ▪ 1GB NVidia® GeForce GT 720M
Display	▪ 14" HD WLED Display ▪ 14" HD LED Touch Display
Security	McAfee® Security Center 15 Months

✎ The price for Inspiron 14 Laptop will vary depending on the model type chosen. Different model types are available with a combination of different types of processors, memory, graphic cards and display for Inspiron 14 Laptop.

4.3.3. Inspiron 15 Laptop

This laptop is affordable, comes with a thin design, a 10-key number pad and has up to 4th Generation Intel® Core™ processors.



Features of New Inspiron 15 Laptop series

Feature	Inspiron 15 Laptop series
Price	Rs. 25,990/- to Rs. 60,790/-
Processor	- Intel® Pentium™ processor 2127U - Intel® Celeron® processor 1017U 3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i3-3217U 3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i3-3227U 4th Gen Intel® Core™ i5-4200U 4th Gen Intel® Core™ i5-4200U
Operating System (OS)	- Ubuntu Linux 12.04 - Windows 8 Single Language
Memory	2GB - 8GB RAM, 500GB - 1TB HDD
Graphic Card	- Intel® HD Graphics - Intel® HD Graphics 4000 - Intel® HD Graphics 4400 1GB AMD Radeon™ HD 7670M 2GB AMD Radeon HD 8670M 2GB AMD Radeon™ HD 8730M 2GB AMD Radeon HD 8850M
Display	15.6" HD WLED Display 15.6" HD WLED Touch Display 15.6" HD LED Touch Display
Security	- McAfee® Security Center 15 Months - McAfee eCard and CD

✎ The price for Inspiron 15 Laptop will vary depending on the model type chosen. Different model types are available with a combination of different types of processors, memory, graphic cards and display for Inspiron 15 Laptop.

5. Dell Vostro

Dell Vostro is ideal for small businesses as it is budget-friendly, robust, reliable and long-lasting. The Vostro line is more affordable than the Inspiron line, but comes with shorter technical support hours. The customer has the choice to opt out of the 24/7 technical support contract from

Dell and pay less for their equipment. Out of the many models available, the Dell Vostro 2420 and Dell Vostro 2520 models are top-selling models. The following table lists a comparison of the features of both these models.



Features of Dell Vostro series

Feature	Vostro 2420	Vostro 2520
Price	Rs. 37,690/- to Rs. 44,590/-	Rs. 30,690/- to Rs. 44,090/-
Processor	3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i5-3230M	3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i3-3110M 3rd Gen Intel® Core™ i5-3230M
Operating System (OS)	- Ubuntu Linux 12.04 - Windows 8 Single Language	- Ubuntu Linux 12.04 - Windows 8 Single Language
Memory	4GB RAM, 500GB HDD	2GB -4GB RAM, 500GB HDD
Graphic Card	Intel® HD Graphics 4000	Intel® HD Graphics 4000
Display	14" HD WLED Anti-Glare	15.6" HD WLED Anti-Glare
Security		McAfee eCard and CD

 The price for the Vostro model will vary depending on the model type chosen. Different model types are available with a combination of different types of processors, memory, graphic cards and display for both the models.